

Stop the Hack

Phishing Awareness Training

Simple, everyday steps to protect yourself and our company from digital scammers.

The Size of the Problem

3.4 B

> Fake Emails Daily

Hackers Don't Break In ... They Log In.

That is 3.4 billion attempts every single day to trick someone into giving away their password.

Cybercriminals don't need complex hacking tools if they can simply **ask you for the keys** by pretending to be someone you trust. Because of this, YOU are our strongest and most important defense.

Mind Games: How Scammers Trick Us

Phishing isn't just about bad computer links; it's about **playing with your emotions** so you act quickly without thinking.

Where Scams Happen



Email (Phishing)

The classic scam. You get a fake email claiming your account is locked, an invoice is unpaid, or you have a package waiting. They want you to click a link.



Texts (Smishing)

Fake text messages that pop up on your phone. Because they arrive right next to texts from your family, people are much more likely to trust and click them.



Phone (Vishing)

Scammers call you directly, often pretending to be the IT Helpdesk, your bank, or the government. They try to scare you into handing over passwords over the phone.

Targeted Attacks: They Know About You

Sometimes, hackers do their homework. They look at your social media or our company website to make their fake messages look incredibly real.

- > **Targeted Phishing:** An email meant just for you. It might mention your specific job title, a project you are working on, or even your boss's name.
- > **Boss Impersonation:** A fake email pretending to be the CEO or your manager, telling you to quickly buy gift cards or pay an urgent bill for a "secret project."

Rule of thumb: If it involves money or passwords, always double-check.



How the Trap Works

Step 1: The Bait (Emotion)

They write a message designed to make you panic, get excited, or feel curious so you stop thinking clearly.

Fear: "Your email password expires in 1 hour!"

Greed: "You won the company raffle!"

Authority: "This is HR, please review this complaint."

Step 2: The Hook (Action)

Once you are emotional, they ask you to take an action that springs the trap.

The Link: They ask you to click a link to a fake website that looks like Microsoft or Google, just to steal your password when you type it in.

The File: They attach a fake "Invoice.pdf" that actually hides a computer virus.

How to Check a Link Safely

Don't click blindly! Take 3 seconds to check if a link is safe before you click.

> Hover, Don't Click

Put your mouse pointer over the link or button **without clicking**. A small box will pop up showing you where the link actually goes.

> Check the Spelling

Read the web address carefully. Scammers use tricks like replacing an 'o' with a zero (e.g., [micr0soft.com](#) instead of [microsoft.com](#)).

> When in Doubt, Type it Out

If you get an email from your bank, don't use the link. Open a new window and type the bank's address yourself.



Real-Life Examples



The Fake Bill

An employee received an email that looked exactly like a real bill from a normal supplier. The only difference was the bank account number. The company lost \$50,000 paying the hacker.



The IT Alert Text

Workers got text messages saying, "IT Alert: Click here to secure your work account." Those who clicked the link accidentally gave hackers full access to the company network.



The Gift Card Scam

An assistant got an urgent email from the "CEO" asking them to buy \$500 in Apple gift cards for a client reward and text the codes. It was a hacker who had faked the boss's email address.

Pop Quiz: What Would You Do?

From: HR-Dept@company-updates.com

"URGENT: Your employee benefits will be paused tomorrow.
Please click here to sign in and review the new policy
immediately to avoid losing coverage."

What should your next step be?

Answer: Stop, Look, and Report



Do NOT Click!

Did you notice the red flags in the quiz?

- > **The strange email address:** It came from "company-updates.com" instead of our normal company email.
- > **The fake urgency:** They tried to scare you by saying benefits would be "paused tomorrow".

The Right Action: Click the "Report Phishing" button in your email program. If you are ever worried it might be real, call the HR department directly on the phone to ask.

Your 3 Golden Rules



When in doubt, throw it out.

If an email feels strange, unexpected, or makes you feel rushed, it is probably a scam. Trust your gut. Delete it or report it to IT.



Verify using a different method.

If you get an email asking you to change a bank account, pay a sudden bill, or share a password, DO NOT reply to the email. Call the person on the phone to double-check.



Use Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).

When you log in, you need your password AND a code on your phone. This is like a double-lock on a door. Even if a hacker steals your password, they can't get in without your phone. Always use it!

System Secure.

You are our best defense against hackers.

Always Think Before You Click.

Questions? Contact the IT Security Team

security@ourcompany.com | Call Ext. 4321

Image Sources



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